FIRST JOHN

Conversational Version

Life and Light

1:[1]What was from the beginning, what we've heard and seen, what we've observed and touched about the living message—[2]the eternal life that was with the Father and he revealed to us—that's what [3]we're passing along to you so we can have it in common with you as well as with the Father and his Son Jesus Christ[Messiah]. [4]We're writing these things *to you* to fully share our joy. **1 Jn 1:1-4**

[5]The message is that God is light; there's no darkness in him at all. [6]If we claim to be in fellowship with him and live in the dark, we're lying and not practicing the truth. [7]If we live in the light with him, we have fellowship with each other, and the blood of his Son continues to cleanse us from sin. [8-10]If we claim we don't have any sin, we deceive ourselves and make God a liar. If we admit we've sinned, we can trust him to be just and forgive us of everything. **1 Jn 1:5-10**

Christ Our Advocate

2:[1]My little children, I'm writing so you'll continue not to sin. If any of us <u>do</u> sin, we have an Advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the Just. [2]He's the basis for forgiving <u>our</u> sins as well as the sins of the whole world. [3]We can tell we know him by whether we're keeping his commandments. [4]If we claim to know him but don't obey him, we're not telling the truth and don't have it. [5]If we keep God's word, we really have loved God completely. That's how we can tell we're in him. [6]If we claim to be in him, we should be like him. **1 Jn 2:1-6**

Love, the New Commandment

[7]Friends, I'm not telling you anything new; it's what you've heard all along. [8]Then again, I <u>am</u> saying something new, something that's true in him and us: darkness is disappearing, and true light is already shining. [9]People that claim to be enlightened and hate fellow believers are still in the dark. [11]They don't know where they're going because they can't see in the dark. [10]Whoever loves a fellow believer is in the light and doesn't make people stumble.

[12]I'm writing to you little children
because he's forgiven your sins.
[13]I'm writing to you fathers
because you've known the One that's from the beginning.
I'm writing to you young men
because you've overcome the evil one.
[14]<u>I've written</u> to you children

because you've known the Father.
I've written to you fathers
because you've known the One that's from the beginning.
I've written to you young men
because you're strong;
God's message remains in you, and
you've overcome the evil one. **1 Jn 2:7-14**

[15]Don't love the world or what's in it. Loving the world means not loving the Father. [16]Nothing worldly comes from the Father; the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life come from the world. [17]The world will pass away along with its lust, but whoever does God's will lasts forever. **1 Jn 2:15-17**

The Antichrist

[18]Little children, we're in the last hour. You've heard that antichrist is coming, and lots of antichrists have already come; so we know we're in the last hour. [19]Some people have left us, but they weren't part of us, or they would've stayed; leaving us shows they weren't part of us. [20]You have an anointing from the Holy One, and you all know *what you need to know*. [21]I'm not writing to tell you something you don't know, but because you do know it and because there's a difference between false and true. [22]Who's telling what's false if it's not someone that denies Jesus is the Christ[Messiah]? It's the antichrist that denies the Father and the Son. [23]Nobody that denies the Son has the Father either; anybody that acknowledges the Son has both. [24]Let what you've heard from the beginning stick with you. If you do, you'll continue to be in the Son and the Father, [25]and you'll have the eternal life he promised.

[26]I'm writing about the ones that are trying to mislead you. [27]The anointing you received from him is still in you; you don't need anybody to teach you *anything more*. His anointing is correct and complete. Stick with what he taught you [28]so when he returns, you'll feel confident, not ashamed. [29]If you know he's good, you know he's begotten everyone that's good. **1 Jn 2:18-29**

Children of God

3:[1]Look at what special love the Father has extended to us in calling us his children. The world doesn't know us because it didn't know him. [2]We're God's children now. It's not clear what we will be, but we do know that when *Christ* returns, we'll be like him and see him as he is. [3]Everybody that has that hope keeps himself pure like he is.

[4]Everybody that practices sin is practicing lawlessness; sin is lawlessness. [5]You know he came to take away sins; there's no sin in him. [6]Nobody that's in him practices sin. If they do, they haven't known him or seen him. [7]Little children, don't let anybody mislead you. Whoever does good is good—like he is. [8]Whoever does evil is like the devil because he's been sinning

since the beginning. The Son of God came to destroy what the devil does. [9]None of the ones God begets practices sin because *God's* seed stays in them. They can't be sinning because God's begotten them. [10]That's how you can tell God's children from the devil's. Anybody that doesn't practice goodness or care about fellow believers, doesn't belong to God. **1 Jn 3:1-10**

Love One Another

[11]You've heard all along that we should love each other [12]and not be like Cain. The evil one influenced him, and he murdered his brother. Why'd he do it? Because what his brother did was good, and what he did was bad. [13]Don't be surprised if the world hates you. [14]We've come from death to life because we love fellow Christians. People that hate fellow Christians are still dead. [15]They *amount to* being murderers *like Cain*, and murderers don't have eternal life. [16]We've known what love is because he showed us by laying his life down for us, and we should lay our lives down for our fellow Christians. [17]How can God's love be in anyone that has this world's possessions, sees what a brother or sister needs, and turns off sympathy for them? [18]Little children, let's not talk about love; let's do it. **1 Jn 3:11-18**

[19]We can have confidence in his presence [20]even if we feel guilty. God's greater than our feelings and knows everything. [21]If our conscience doesn't make us feel guilty, we're confident in front of him, [22]and he gives us what we ask for because we do what pleases him. [23]He has told us to believe in his Son Jesus Christ and love each other. [24]When we do that, he lives in us and we in him. We know he's in us by the spirit he's given us. **1 Jn 3:19-24**

Testing the spirits

4:[1]Friends, don't believe every *prophet that claims to speak by the* spirit. Test whether *his* spirit is from God; a lot of false prophets have gone out. [2]You can recognize that a spirit is from God by whether it agrees that Jesus Christ has come in the flesh. [3]Any spirit that doesn't, isn't from God; it's the antichristian *spirit* that you've heard is coming and is already here. [4]You belong to God. You've triumphed over the world, because the One that's in you is greater than the one that's in it. [5]False leaders belong to the world, so they speak of it, and it listens to them. [6]We belong to God; people that know him listen to us. People that don't belong to him, don't listen to us. That's how you can tell if *a prophet has the* true spirit or a deceiving one. **1 Jn 4:1-6**

God is Love

[7]Let's love each other because love comes from God, and everybody that loves has been begotten by him and knows him. [8]People that don't love don't know God because he is *characterized by* love. [9]God showed that love by sending his only Son into the world so we could have life through him. [10]Love is not so much that we love God as that he's loved us and sent his Son as a basis for forgiving our sins. [11]If God loved us that much, we should love each

other. [12]Nobody has ever seen God; *but* if we love each other, he's in us and his love has accomplished its purpose in us. **1 Jn 4:7-12**

[13]We know he's in us and we're in him by the spirit he's given us. [14]We've seen and speak to the fact that the Father has sent the Son to save the world. [15]If anybody agrees that Jesus is God's Son, God's in him and he's in God. [16]We've known and believed that God has put his love in us. God is *characterized by* love and whoever keeps loving keeps being in God and God keeps being in him. [17]Love ends up giving us confidence at judgment time because we're like he was in the world. [18]There's no fear in love; perfect love eliminates fear because fear corresponds with punishment; whoever is afraid has not become perfect at loving. [19]Let's love because he loved us first. [20]If people say they love God and hate fellow Christians, they're not telling the truth. If they don't love Christians they've seen, they can't be loving God they've not seen. [21]We have this commandment from him: whoever loves God must love God's children too. **1 Jn 4:13-21**

Victory by Faith

5:[1]Everybody that believes Jesus is the Christ[Messiah] has been begotten by God, and everybody that loves the begetter loves the begotten. [2]We can tell we love God's children by whether we love God and do what he says. [3]Loving God means keeping his commandments without feeling like they're burdensome. [4]The ones God begets triumph over the world, and faith makes that triumph possible. [5]Who triumphs over the world except the one that believes Jesus is God's Son?

1 Jn 5:1-5

Witnesses for Christ

[6]Jesus Christ came by water (*at his baptism*) and blood (*on his cross*), not just by water. The Spirit is the One that bears witness, because the Spirit is *characterized by* truth. [7]There are three witnesses: [8]the Spirit, the water, and the blood; and they agree. [9]We accept what people tell us; what God tells us is more important. God has told us about his Son. [10]Whoever believes in his Son accepts what *God* has told us; whoever doesn't, makes God a liar. [11]God has told us that eternal life lies in the Son. [12]Whoever has the Son has *that* life; whoever doesn't have him, doesn't have it. **1 Jn 5:6-12**

Confidence in Christ

[13]I've written these things to you that believe in God's Son in order to make you confident that you have eternal life. [14]This is the confidence we have with him: whatever we ask for according to his will he listens to. [15]If we know he <u>listens to</u> what we ask for, we know he <u>answers</u> what we ask for. **1 Jn 5:13-15**

16If you see a fellow believer doing some sin that doesn't lead to death, ask God and he'll give him life. There <u>is</u> a kind of sin that does lead to death; I'm not saying you should ask about that. **17**All unrighteousness is sin, but there are sins that don't lead to death. **1 Jn 5:16-17**

18People that God begets don't practice sinning; they keep themselves *from sinning*, and the evil one doesn't touch them. **19**We belong to God, and the world belongs to the evil one. **20**God's Son came so we could understand what's true. We're in the true One, *God's* Son Jesus Christ. <u>He</u>'s true deity and eternal life. **21**Little children, stay away from idols. **1 Jn 5:18-21**

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